

Etching a golden era in Tamilnadu 2 years of progress...

■ A Pioneering effort to develop all the 12,618 villages by 2011 and Poverty alleviation is the Prime Motto of Tamil Nadu

The Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Department is responsible for the implementation of various centrally- Sponsored, state-funded, and extremely-aided schemes for poverty alleviation, employment generation, sanitation, capacity building, womens social and economic empowerment, Tsunami rehabilitation, etc., Apart from provision of basic amenities and services.

There are 12,618 village panchayats, 385 panchayat unions (co-terminus with blocks) and 29 district panchayats under the purview of the department.

■ Local bodies' vital role

The prime services of local bodies are to provide infrastructure facilities such as water supply, sewage system, street lights, public health, roads besides effective Waste management. Tamilnadu is one among the most urbanized states in india with 43.86% of state population living in urban Tamilnadu. The rate of urbanization in Tamilnadu doubled from about 22% in 1961 to the present level in 2001.

Tamilnadu is a pioneer in bringing reforms in the administration of local bodies, specially urban bodies. The



Self help groups getting Revolving Fund from Hon'ble Minister M.K. Stalin

three tier structure of the urban local bodies is unique to the state of Tamilnadu.

■ The glorious saga of Self Help Groups in transforming poorer livelihoods

It was not with any selfish political motive Hon'ble Chief Minister Dr. Kalam Karunanidhi started the women Self Help Groups (SHG) in 1989. The core objective of moulding women from economical weaker strata of the society in to self-supporting enterprising individuals dreamt then by the Chief Minister is now becoming true by the robust growth of the movement all over the state.

The state now prides of 3.67 lakh women SHGs with a total enrolment of around 59.07 lakh women. The state further scores impressively on the rural side with a whopping 2.59 lakh SHGs followed by its urban counterpart of around 1.07 lakh SHGs. The total savings made by the SHGs are a massive sum of around Rs.1,826 crore with 44, 208 of SHGs availing the Revolving Fund of the savings.

■ Anna Renaissance Scheme:

With no precedence in the past of the state administration the ruling DMK government has initiated a mega funding programme under Anna Renaissance scheme by allocating Rs. 20 lakh each to 12,618 village panchayats in the state. Hitherto, a sum of Rs. 2, 524 crores is being disbursed by the government for 5 years. Through the ambitious scheme, the government wishes to fulfill its lofty objective of raising the rural infrastructure and amenities on par with the urbanized areas of the state.

Women self help group on their production

